

Comprehensive Reference: Arabic Case Endings

A Structural Blueprint of Singular, Dual, and Broken Plural Forms

1 The Core Principle of Arabic I'rāb (Vocalization)

[0.8pt]

In Classical and Quranic Arabic, the final vowel or letter configuration of a noun changes systematically depending on its structural role within a sentence:

- **Nominative Case** [مَرْفُوع – Marfūʿ]: Typically marked by a **ḍamma** [ُ] on singular nouns. It indicates the Subject or Doer performing the action.
- **Accusative Case** [مَنْصُوب – Manṣūb]: Typically marked by a **fatḥa** [َ] on singular nouns. It identifies the Direct Object receiving the action.
- **Genitive Case** [مُجْرُور – Majrūr]: Typically marked by a **kasra** [ِ] on singular nouns. It specifies possession or follows a grammatical preposition.

2 Illustrative Sentences: The Three Primary Cases

[0.8pt]

2.1 2.1 Nominative → The Doer

Sentence Structure: Verb + Doer + Object

Example Text:

Transliteration: *Khalaqa Allāhu al-insāna*

Syntactic Breakdown:

خلق الله الإنسان

- **Verb:** خلق (*Khalaqa*) → Created
- **Doer / Subject:** الله (*Allāhu*) → Marked by the final ḍamma
- **Direct Object:** الإنسان (*al-insāna*) → Mankind

Translation: “Allah created mankind.”

2.2 2.2 Accusative → The Receiver

Example Text:

Transliteration: *Naṣara ar-rajulu Yūsufa*

Syntactic Breakdown:

نصر الرجل يوسف

- **Verb:** نصر (*Naṣara*) → Helped

- **Doer / Subject:** الرَّجُل (ar-rajulu) → The man (Marked by damma)
- **Direct Object / Receiver:** يُوْسُف (Yūsufa) → Joseph (Marked by the final fatha)

Translation: “The man helped Joseph.”

2.3 2.3 Genitive → Possession or Prepositional Object

Example A (Possession):

كِتَابُ الرَّجُل

Transliteration: Kitābu ar-rajuli

Meaning: “The man’s book” / “The book of the man.” (Marked by the final kasra)

Example B (After a Preposition):

ذَهَبْتُ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ

Transliteration: Dhahabtu ilā al-masjidi

Syntactic Breakdown:

- **Phrase:** ذَهَبْتُ (Dhahabtu) → I went
- **Preposition:** إِلَى (ilā) → To
- **Prepositional Object:** الْمَسْجِدِ (al-masjidi) → The mosque (Marked by the final kasra)

Translation: “I went to the mosque.”

3 The Complete Declension Framework for the Root: ل - ج - ر

[0.8pt]

Grammatical Number	Case	Arabic Form	Transliteration	Primary Syntactic Function
Singular (One Man)	Nominative	الرَّجُلُ	<i>ar-rajulu</i>	Sentence Subject / Doer
	Accusative	الرَّجُلَ	<i>ar-rajula</i>	Direct Object / Receiver
	Genitive	الرَّجُلِ	<i>ar-rajuli</i>	Post-Preposition / Possession
Dual (Two Men)	Nominative	الرَّجُلَانِ	<i>ar-rajulāni</i>	Sentence Subject / Doer
	Accusative	الرَّجُلَيْنِ	<i>ar-rajulayni</i>	Direct Object / Receiver
	Genitive	الرَّجُلَيْنِ	<i>ar-rajulayni</i>	Post-Preposition / Possession
Broken Plural (Three or More Men)	Nominative	الرِّجَالُ	<i>ar-rijālu</i>	Sentence Subject / Doer
	Accusative	الرِّجَالَ	<i>ar-rijāla</i>	Direct Object / Receiver
	Genitive	الرِّجَالِ	<i>ar-rijāli</i>	Post-Preposition / Possession

Table 1: Systematic Declinational Blueprint of the Noun: رَجُلٌ

4 Structural Contrast: The Vowel Swap Experiment

[0.8pt]

Shifting the short vowels re-allocates semantic meaning entirely without modifying word order:

Historical Quranic Fact

قتل داود جالوت

Qatala Dāwūdu Jālūta

داود → The Doer / Subject (David / marked by ḍamma)

جالوت → The Object (Goliath / marked by fatḥa)

Meaning: “David killed Goliath.”

Inverted Semantic Paradox

قتل داود جالوت

Qatala Dāwūda Jālūtu

داود → The Object (David / marked by fatḥa)

جالوت → The Doer / Subject (Goliath / marked by ḍamma)

Meaning: “Goliath killed David.”

This document serves as an analytical reference guide for Classical Arabic morphology and syntax grammar tracking.